

FOSS Security Tools: WhatWeb

In this second article in the series on FOSS security tools, we will learn about WhatWeb, a next generation web scanner.



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WhatWeb can be used to recognise web servers, JavaScript libraries, blogging platforms and content management systems (CMS). It is written by Andrew Horton and Brendan Coles using the Ruby programming language. The source code is released under the GNU General Public License v2.0. You can install the same on Ubuntu using the following command:

```
$ sudo apt install whatweb
```

The `--version` argument can be used to identify the installed version as shown below:

```
$ whatweb --version
WhatWeb version 0.5.5 ( https://www.morningstarsecurity.com/research/whatweb/ )
```

Help

You can view the help summary using the `-h` option as indicated below:

```
$ whatweb -h
...
```

WhatWeb - Next generation web scanner version 0.5.5.
Developed by Andrew Horton (urbanadventurer) and Brendan

Coles (bcoles).

Homepage: <https://www.morningstarsecurity.com/research/whatweb>

Usage: `whatweb [options] <URLs>`

TARGET SELECTION:

`<TARGETS>` Enter URLs, hostnames, IP addresses, filenames or

IP ranges in CIDR, `x.x.x-x`, or `x.x.x.x-x.x.x.x` format.

`--input-file=FILE, -i` Read targets from a file. You can pipe

hostnames or URLs directly with `-i /dev/stdin`.

TARGET MODIFICATION:

`--url-prefix` Add a prefix to target URLs.

`--url-suffix` Add a suffix to target URLs.

`--url-pattern` Insert the targets into a URL.
e.g. `example.com/%insert%/robots.txt`

Verbosity

The verbosity level can be specified with the `-v` argument as follows:

```
$ whatweb -v google.com
```